

the scheme of things, and they were the men I had admired more than the others, who saw only their own ability to ride the crest of the timely wave. The ones who had had perspective upon life also tended to be the ones who had peace of mind. They were very big men, some of them, but they knew the world around them was bigger than they, and considerably more important.

Andrew Carnegie was well aware of this. At one time he believed that I was beginning to assume a feeling of superiority because of my association with him. He had me write out the following motto:

“Don’t take yourself too damned seriously, unless you wish to be damned by others.”

This motto did me some good at the time, later faded into my submerged memories; perhaps it was at such times as when I could be happy with nothing less than two Rolls-Royces.

Now I see there was nothing wrong with the Rolls-Royces, nor with my Catskill Mountain estate for that matter; it was my attitude that was wrong. I took myself too “damned” seriously. The splash I made in the world mattered more than my respect for the world which had given me my opportunities.

I look back upon that time and upon similar times, and I see I had a peculiarly guilty conscience. I had committed no crimes. In those days, however, if a glance into the rear-view mirror of my Rolls-Royce showed a traffic policeman coming up behind, I grew instantly uneasy even if I was driving several miles an hour under the speed limit. As for a policeman’s coming to my door . . . if it ever had happened, I would have quaked in my boots.

Whence came the fear? Surely from the tensions I had worked up. Now those tensions are gone, for I know my place in the world and my mind is at peace. Now, when I see a traffic policeman coming up behind my car, I am glad to see him, for I know that his presence evokes careful driving and fewer hazards on the road.

And finally, a short time ago, a policeman in uniform did ring my doorbell. It was only after he had gone that I realized I *might* have felt some apprehension—but I didn’t. I was merely curious to know why he had come to my door. He asked me politely if a certain person lived in my house. No, I informed him, that person once had lived in the house, but